



# General Assembly

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Agenda item 159

**Financing of the activities arising from Security Council  
resolution 1863 (2009)**

### **Budget performance for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 and budget for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 for the United Nations Support Office in Somalia**

#### **Report of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions**

|                                                                 |               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Appropriation for 2024/25                                       | \$499,765,200 |
| Allotment for 2024/25                                           | \$486,329,800 |
| Expenditure for 2024/25                                         | \$486,293,900 |
| Unencumbered balance for 2024/25                                | \$13,471,300  |
| Appropriation for 2025/26                                       | \$520,627,900 |
| Projected expenditure for 2025/26 <sup>a</sup>                  | \$390,721,100 |
| Projected underexpenditure for 2025/26 <sup>b</sup>             | \$129,906,800 |
| Proposal submitted by the Secretary-General for 2026/27         | \$481,671,800 |
| Adjustment recommended by the Advisory Committee<br>for 2026/27 | (\$121,400)   |
| Recommendation of the Advisory Committee for 2026/27            | \$481,550,400 |

<sup>a</sup> Estimates as at 28 February 2026.

<sup>b</sup> Excludes one-time resource requirements to provide for termination entitlements payable to staff members.



## I. Introduction

1. During its consideration of the advance version of the report of the Secretary-General on the financing of the United Nations Support Office in Somalia (UNSOS) (A/80/628), the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions met with representatives of the Secretary-General, who provided additional information and clarification, concluding with written responses received on 27 March 2026. The comments and recommendations of the Committee on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations are contained in its report (A/80/604), while those pertaining to the findings and recommendations of the Board of Auditors on the United Nations peacekeeping operations for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 can be found in its related report (A/80/633).

## II. Budget performance report for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025

2. By its resolution 78/309, the General Assembly appropriated an amount of \$499,765,200 gross (\$491,555,600 net) for the maintenance of UNSOS for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025. Expenditures for the period totalled \$486,293,900 gross (\$476,705,900 net), representing a resource utilization rate of 97.3 per cent, reflecting the impact of: (a) higher-than-budgeted requirements under military and police personnel (\$6,116,700, or 5.5 per cent); (b) higher-than-budgeted requirements under civilian personnel (\$7,707,800, or 8.3 per cent); and (c) lower-than-budgeted requirements for operational costs (\$27,295,800, or 9.3 per cent).

3. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that redeployments in the amount of \$13,824,500 from group III (operational costs) to group I (military and police personnel) and group II (civilian personnel) were primarily due to the continued higher-than-budgeted deployment of personnel from the African Union Transition Mission in Somalia (ATMIS)/African Union Support and Stabilization Mission in Somalia (AUSSOM) throughout the period, as well as lower vacancy and higher salary rates for civilian personnel. Reduced requirements for group III (operational costs) were mainly related to lower costs under air operations and the prioritization of resources in response to the liquidity challenges. The Committee was further informed that the higher costs for uniformed personnel due to adjustments to authorized strength during the period required UNSOS to defer or scale back certain planned operational activities and expenditures in other areas, reflecting the challenge of synchronizing mandate decisions affecting force levels with the budget formulation cycle within a hybrid operational framework (see para. 14 below). **The Advisory Committee trusts that more detailed information on redeployments will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report, in particular on activities curtailed and other lower-than-budgeted expenditures that allowed for resources to be redeployed, as well as the criteria used by UNSOS to reprioritize resources.**

4. The Advisory Committee notes from information provided to it that, as at 30 June 2025, unliquidated obligations for 2024/25 amounted to \$75,315,000, representing 15.07 per cent of the appropriation for that period and an increase of \$3,429,300 compared with the amount of \$71,885,700 as at 30 June 2024 for the 2023/24 period. Upon enquiry, the Committee was informed that, as at 31 January 2026, unliquidated obligations for the financial period 2024/25 had decreased to \$17,550,600, comprising: (a) \$12,129,800 for military and police personnel; (b) \$1,500 for civilian personnel; and (c) \$5,419,300 for operational costs.

5. The unencumbered balance for the 2024/25 period, in gross terms, amounts to \$13,471,300, or 2.7 per cent of the total resources approved for the financial period. A detailed analysis of variances is provided in section III of the report of the Secretary-General (A/80/628). As indicated in section II.F of the report, other revenue and adjustments for the period amount to \$3,884,000, comprising: (a) investment revenue (\$199,700); (b) other/miscellaneous revenue (\$37,700); and (c) the cancellation of prior-period obligations (\$3,646,600). The Advisory Committee notes that, in his report, the Secretary-General proposes to place credits of \$17,355,300 comprising the unencumbered balance (\$13,471,300) and other revenue (\$3,884,000) in a reserve that would be used in the event that collections are insufficient to enable implementation of the mandate (*ibid.*, subparas. 100 (a)–(c); see para. 55 below).

6. In the 2024/25 period, owing to its cash liquidity situation, UNSOS received loans from the Peacekeeping Reserve Fund and other active peacekeeping missions (the United Nations Organization Stabilization Mission in the Democratic Republic of the Congo (MONUSCO), the United Nations Interim Force in Lebanon (UNIFIL), the United Nations Disengagement Observer Force (UNDOF) and the United Nations Peacekeeping Force in Cyprus (UNFICYP)). The borrowing fluctuated throughout the period, starting at \$89.5 million at the end of July 2024 and peaking at \$113.0 million at the end of June 2025 (*ibid.*, para. 57; see also para. 10 below). As reported by the Board of Auditors, as at 30 June 2025, five missions accounted for the majority of inter-mission borrowing during the 2024/25 financial period, with UNSOS representing 57 per cent of the total (A/80/5 (Vol. II), chap. II, para. 215).

*Matters pertaining to the report of the Board of Auditors*

7. In considering the report of the Secretary-General, the Advisory Committee also had before it the report of the Board of Auditors on the accounts of the United Nations peacekeeping operations for the financial period ended 30 June 2025 (A/80/5 (Vol. II)). Regarding UNSOS, the Board noted deficiencies pertaining to fuel management, including the high risk of being unable to recover financial losses of \$12.59 million due to the non-performance of a former fuel supplier at UNSOS; the impact of liquidity constraints, including on air operations; and the reduction of 15 per cent of the financial agreement for the Mine Action Service in UNSOS (*ibid.*, chap. II, paras. 92, 94–97, 267, 272 and 275; see also paras. 42 and 46 below). **The Advisory Committee trusts that the recommendations of the Board of Auditors will be implemented in a timely manner.**

### III. Information on performance for the current period

8. Regarding current and projected expenditure for the period from 1 July 2025 to 30 June 2026, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 28 February 2026, expenditure amounted to \$244,712,600. At the end of the current financial period, the estimated total expenditure would be \$390,721,100, with a projected unencumbered balance of \$129,906,800,<sup>1</sup> or 25 per cent of the appropriation.

9. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, due to the liquidity challenges experienced by the United Nations and in line with guidance from the Secretary-General, UNSOS had implemented contingency measures, including a 25 per cent reduction in expenditure within the current budget period. The higher percentage reduction target for UNSOS, compared with the 15 per cent applied to other peacekeeping missions, reflects the more constrained liquidity position of the Support Office, owing to its cash flow profile and significantly reduced projected

<sup>1</sup> Excludes one-time requirements for termination entitlements payable to staff members.

cash inflows during the current period. The Support Office reprioritized activities, focusing on the most critical operational requirements, while deferring non-essential acquisitions, repairs, maintenance and other discretionary spending. For example, fuel reserves were reduced, the stocks of combat ration packs were depleted and none of the assets planned for 2025/26 had been procured to date. Operational continuity was maintained through reserve assets, strategic stocks and the extension of the useful life of existing equipment. The Advisory Committee was further informed that, while the contingency plan incorporated limited efficiency-oriented measures, such as vacancy management and asset redeployment, the reductions did not result from structural efficiencies. Rather, they constituted temporary cost compression arising from liquidity constraints, which reduced operational flexibility, maintenance cycles and surge capacity and generated no structural efficiency gains. Despite these challenges, UNSOS continued to deliver mandated logistical support by prioritizing mission-critical activities and coordinating closely with AUSSOM to align resources with essential functions. **The Advisory Committee notes that UNSOS is the only peacekeeping operation requested to implement a 25 per cent expenditure reduction during the 2025/26 period under its contingency plan. The Committee further notes that the reductions identified in the 2025/26 period do not arise from structural efficiencies and have reduced operational flexibility, maintenance cycles and surge capacity. The Committee trusts that all efforts will be undertaken to ensure the security and safety of personnel. The Committee also trusts that an updated and more detailed assessment of the impact of the contingency plan on the implementation of the mandate of UNSOS will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the report and in the next performance report.**

10. Information provided to the Advisory Committee indicates that, as at 13 February 2026, a total of \$8,611,093,000 had been assessed on Member States in respect of UNSOS since its inception. Payments received as at the same date amounted to \$8,197,372,000, leaving an outstanding balance of \$413,721,000. Furthermore, as at 16 February 2026, the cash available to UNSOS was \$134,475,892, inclusive of \$109.5 million borrowed from the Peacekeeping Reserve Fund and UNIFIL, based on General Assembly resolution [76/272](#), which was sufficient to cover the three-month operating reserve of \$113,785,550. **The Advisory Committee notes that the outstanding contributions of \$413.7 million represent approximately 79.5 per cent of the \$520.6 million appropriation for 2025/26. The Committee reiterates its concern regarding the serious and persistent challenge of the cash position of UNSOS and its continued need for the borrowing of funds to meet its operational requirements. The Committee recalls that the General Assembly has urged Member States, in particular those in arrears, to ensure payment of their outstanding assessed contributions (resolution [79/312](#), para. 1).**

11. The Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 31 December 2025, there was an outstanding balance of \$31,500 for the reimbursement of uniformed personnel costs and \$43,298,400 for contingent-owned equipment. **The Advisory Committee trusts that all outstanding liabilities will be settled in a timely manner.**

## **IV. Proposed budget for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027**

### **A. Mandate and planning assumptions**

12. The mandate of UNSOS was established by the Security Council in resolution [1863 \(2009\)](#) and was most recently extended until 31 December 2026 in Council

resolution [2809 \(2025\)](#). During the 2026/27 period, UNSOS will continue to provide logistical support to AUSSOM under an evolving operational configuration and support to the Somali security forces and will deliver administrative and logistical support to the United Nations Transitional Assistance Mission in Somalia (UNTMIS), on a cost-recovery basis, until its planned closure by 31 October 2026 and thereafter during its in situ liquidation.

*Provision of the logistical support package to the African Union Support and Stabilization Mission in Somalia*

13. For the 2026/27 period, UNSOS support will continue to be aligned with the phased implementation of the AUSSOM strategic concept of operations (2024) (see Security Council resolution [2767 \(2024\)](#)). Phase 1, which was conducted from 1 January to 1 July 2025, was focused on the realignment of troops and the transfer of locations to Somali security forces in preparation for the handover from ATMIS to AUSSOM. Phase 2, which will run until 31 December 2027, comprises three subphases: the securing of mission locations (phase 2a), support for offensive operations (phase 2b) and support for sustainment activities (phase 2c). Support will be tailored to the evolving operational requirements of AUSSOM and the broader security context ([A/80/628](#), para. 15).

14. The Advisory Committee notes that phase 1 of the approved concept of operations planned for the realignment of troops and the transfer of locations to Somali security forces and recalls that the budget for UNSOS for 2024/25 was proposed and approved on the basis of 10,626 ATMIS personnel, in accordance with Security Council resolution [2710 \(2023\)](#), but 12,626 were retained throughout the same period, pursuant to resolution [2741 \(2024\)](#). Subsequently, in paragraph 21 of its resolution [2767 \(2024\)](#), the Council adjusted the authorized ceiling to 11,826 uniformed personnel beginning from 1 July 2025, which resulted in movements of contingents during the current budget period, including the repatriation of one formed police unit and 470 defence forces personnel, together with associated contingent-owned equipment. These developments generated unbudgeted costs in the 2025/26 period, which UNSOS is seeking to absorb within existing resources, notwithstanding liquidity constraints.

15. While noting that AUSSOM is now in phase 2, the Advisory Committee was informed that, although the concept of operations envisaged a reduction to 14 main operating bases and 9 tactical bases during the current period, security considerations led the tripartite technical committee (comprising the Federal Government of Somalia, AUSSOM and UNSOS) to maintain 49 forward operating bases across five sectors. The structure of the current sector and forward operating bases will also be maintained in the 2026/27 period, and one additional main operating base will be constructed in sector 3 in connection with the reconfiguration of AUSSOM. As the reconfiguration of AUSSOM remains an ongoing process, further repatriation, deployments of contingents and formed police units, and the movement of associated contingent-owned equipment remain under consideration and subject to available resources. The Committee was also informed that the balance of the trust fund in support of AUSSOM was \$422,800 as at 26 March 2026.

16. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, in preparing its budgets, UNSOS relies on the most recent planning parameters available, while maintaining sufficient flexibility in resource utilization to accommodate adjustments arising from the evolving operational environment and the ongoing reconfiguration of AUSSOM.

**17. The Advisory Committee notes that the realignment of troops and transfer of locations to Somali forces planned for phase 1 has not resulted in a reduction**

of the AUSSOM footprint. The Committee also notes that the ongoing reconfiguration of AUSSOM is expected to entail further adjustments in force levels, contingent deployments and movement of associated contingent-owned equipment, as well as adjustments in the number of bases, with implications for UNSOS operational planning. The Committee trusts that the Secretary-General will provide further information to the General Assembly, at the time of its consideration of the present report, on developments relating to the reconfiguration of AUSSOM and their resource implications.

*Support to Somali security forces*

18. UNSOS will continue to provide mandated logistics support to the Somali security forces engaged in joint or coordinated operations with AUSSOM through the United Nations trust fund established by Security Council resolution [2124 \(2013\)](#) (ibid., paras. 19 and 20). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the Fund is fully financed through voluntary contributions and administered by UNSOS. Sustaining core activities and meeting ongoing operational requirements requires approximately \$2.2 million per month; however, as at 9 February 2026, the fund balance stood at \$244,300. The financing base has narrowed to one sole major donor in recent years and no new pledges have been secured, despite intensified resource mobilization in coordination with the Federal Government of Somalia. The Committee was further informed that, owing to the depleted level of resources, support has been reduced to fuel, rations and medical services, while other categories of support, including water, tentage and transportation, have been suspended or deferred. Should the fund be further depleted, all support to Somali forces would be suspended except for life-saving medical evacuation, subject to resource availability. The funding shortfall has implications beyond the sustainment of the Somali security forces, directly affecting the operational effectiveness of AUSSOM in joint stabilization operations. **The Advisory Committee notes with concern the critically low balance of the trust fund in support of the Somali security forces' operations, the limited donor base and the absence of new pledges. The Committee trusts that further efforts will be undertaken to mobilize additional resources and that an update will be provided in the next report (see also [A/79/724/Add.10](#), para. 20; [A/78/744/Add.8](#), para. 17; [A/76/760/Add.12](#), para. 20).**

*Preparation for United Nations Transitional Assistance Mission in Somalia transition*

19. Following the anticipated closure of UNTMIS by 31 October 2026 in accordance with Security Council resolution [2753 \(2024\)](#), UNSOS will implement the UNTMIS mission support transition plan, including the reduction of its physical footprint, environmental cleanup, asset disposal and administrative support ([A/80/628](#), para. 21). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that UNSOS plans to transfer selected UNTMIS assets, where authorized, to the Federal Government of Somalia, in accordance with the applicable regulatory framework, including serviceable, non-sensitive, immovable or difficult to redeploy assets, such as prefabricated buildings. **The Advisory Committee trusts that information on the implications of the disposal of UNTMIS assets for UNSOS asset planning will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and, in greater detail, in the next report. The Committee also looks forward to detailed information on UNTMIS asset disposal in the context of the next report on special political missions under thematic cluster III.**

20. In addition, following the closure of UNTMIS, UNSOS will assume full responsibility for certain essential functions that had previously been cost-shared with UNTMIS, including medical services and armed security (see paras. 40 and 44 below).

UNSOS will also be responsible for the implementation of the human rights due diligence policy in Somalia, pursuant to Security Council resolution 2809 (2025), which has been conducted by UNTMIS to date (A/80/628, para. 22; see also para. 33 below).

*Impact of the UN80 Initiative and culture of efficiency*

21. In his report, the Secretary-General indicates that, in line with the UN80 Initiative, the proposed budget for UNSOS for 2026/27 takes into account targeted efficiency measures, estimated at \$37.1 million. These measures were identified following a comprehensive review of operational requirements, with the objective of preserving the capacity of UNSOS to deliver core mandated activities while operating within a reduced resource envelope (A/80/628, paras. 33 and 53).

22. The efficiency measures taken into account for the 2026/27 budget are outlined in section II.C of the Secretary-General's report and mainly pertain to: (a) air operations (\$18.7 million, or approximately half of the total expected efficiencies), reflecting, inter alia, the termination of two fixed-wing and two rotary aircraft; (b) civilian personnel (\$5.3 million), owing to the proposed abolishment of international posts and United Nations Volunteer positions and nationalizations; (c) mine action (\$5.3 million), due to contractual consolidation and reduction of scope; (d) uniformed personnel (\$2.7 million), attributable to adjustments in the contractual ceiling rate for rations; (e) public communication (\$2.6 million), through the discontinuation of UNSOS support to community radio stations and strategic communication services; and (f) efficiencies related to information and communications technology (ICT) (\$2.4 million). Estimated efficiencies for 2026/27 represent a 7.1 per cent reduction compared to the approved budget for 2025/26, in the context of an overall 7.5 per cent proposed reduction in the budget (see para. 25 below).

23. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the independent strategic review pursuant to Security Council resolution 2767 (2024), conducted in early 2025, identified structural efficiencies amounting to at least \$43.7 million, primarily through force optimization, staffing streamlining, infrastructure rationalization and adjustments to air operations. Building on those findings, UNSOS identified complementary efficiency opportunities through, inter alia, utility and resource optimization, functional streamlining and increased reliance on reserve stocks of the United Nations Logistics Base at Brindisi, Italy. However, the proposed resource requirements also reflect a recalibration to a sustainable operating level, following the liquidity-driven reductions implemented during the 2025/26 period (see para. 9 above), in order to preserve asset integrity, operational resilience under phase 2 of the concept of operations, and mandated support capacity in a challenging environment. Accordingly, during the 2026/27 period, UNSOS plans to rebuild depleted stocks and restore critical sustainment elements to ensure operational continuity, applying a risk-based prioritization framework while maintaining strict expenditure controls and pursuing efficiencies. Any efficiency gains in the 2026/27 period are therefore expected to arise from targeted cost optimization and improved resource management, rather than from reductions that would compromise mission-critical support.

### Summary of the areas of efficiency measures recommended by the independent strategic review and measures implemented under the contingency plan

|                               | <i>Independent strategic review efficiency measures (with amounts)</i>                            | <i>Contingency plan efficiency measures</i>             | <i>Contingency plan cost-reduction measures (impacting capacity)</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Military contingents          | Efficiencies under rations and right-sizing of the contingent-owned equipment                     | Operational reprioritization within existing deployment | Reductions remain within the optimization levels identified by the independent strategic review and have not affected operational capacity at present. However, reductions exceeding these levels would likely affect operational flexibility and reserve capacity. |
| Civilian personnel            | Structured staffing review and streamlining                                                       | Vacancy management and delayed recruitment              | Further reductions beyond efficiency levels would affect workload distribution and delivery timelines.                                                                                                                                                              |
| Facilities and infrastructure | Infrastructure maintenance optimization                                                           | Deferral of non-critical maintenance                    | Further reductions and deferral would increase the risk of accelerated asset deterioration in the harsh operating environment.                                                                                                                                      |
| Ground transportation         | Fleet optimization and utilization review (efficiency gains reflected in reduced operating costs) | Asset redeployment and improved utilization             | Further reductions beyond efficiency levels would limit redundancy and emergency response capacity.                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Air operations                | Revised flight-hour assumptions and air asset optimization                                        | Prioritization of essential air movements               | Further reductions beyond efficiency levels would reduce operational flexibility for contingency and surge requirements.                                                                                                                                            |
| Official travel               | No structural independent strategic review reduction identified                                   | Strict prioritization of mission-critical travel        | Operational restrictions rather than structural efficiency gains.                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

24. The Advisory Committee notes that, while some proposed reductions reflect structural efficiency gains resulting from process improvements, others are driven primarily by liquidity constraints and temporary expenditure compression. The Committee trusts that further information on the connection between the proposed reductions and the expected accomplishments and outputs proposed for the mission for the 2026/27 period will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report to allow for a better assessment of the sustainability and long-term implications of such measures for the implementation of the mandate by the Support Office. The Committee further discusses efficiency measures in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

## B. Resource requirements

25. The proposed requirements for the 2026/27 period amount to \$481,671,800, representing a decrease of \$38,956,100, or 7.5 per cent, compared with resources of \$520,627,900 approved for the 2025/26 period. Information on variances between the apportionment for 2025/26 and the proposed resources for 2026/27 is contained in section III of the budget report.

## Financial resources

(Thousands of United States dollars)

| Category                      | Approved<br>(2024/25) | Expenditure<br>(2024/25) | Approved<br>(2025/26) | Expenditure as at<br>28 February 2026 | Cost<br>estimates<br>(2026/27) | Variance          |              |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------|--------------|
|                               |                       |                          |                       |                                       |                                | Amount            | Percentage   |
| Military and police personnel | 112 100.6             | 118 217.3                | 111 282.5             | 58 383.8                              | 112 903.8                      | 1 621.3           | 1.5          |
| Civilian personnel            | 93 180.6              | 100 888.4                | 98 678.0              | 66 376.2                              | 104 311.7                      | 5 633.7           | 5.7          |
| Operational costs             | 294 484.0             | 267 188.2                | 310 667.4             | 119 952.5                             | 264 456.3                      | (46 211.1)        | (14.9)       |
| <b>Gross requirements</b>     | <b>499 765.2</b>      | <b>486 293.9</b>         | <b>520 627.9</b>      | <b>244 712.6</b>                      | <b>481 671.8</b>               | <b>(38 956.1)</b> | <b>(7.5)</b> |

### 1. Military and police personnel

| Category                                     | Budgeted<br>2024/25 <sup>a</sup> | Actual as at<br>30 June 2025 | Budgeted<br>2025/26 <sup>a</sup> | Actual as at<br>28 February<br>2026 | Authorized<br>and proposed<br>for 2026/27 | Variance |
|----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------------------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------|
| United Nations military contingent personnel | 10                               | 7                            | 10                               | 7                                   | 10                                        | –        |
| ATMIS/AUSSOM military contingent personnel   | 9 586                            | 11 465                       | 11 146                           | 10 654                              | 11 146                                    | –        |
| ATMIS/AUSSOM police personnel                | 240                              | 2                            | 200                              | 3                                   | 200                                       | –        |
| ATMIS/AUSSOM formed police unit personnel    | 800                              | 478                          | 480                              | 477                                 | 480                                       | –        |

<sup>a</sup> Represents the highest level of authorized strength.

## Delayed deployment factors

(Percentage of approved strength)

| Category                                  | Budgeted<br>2024/25 | Actual<br>2024/25   | Approved<br>2025/26 | Actual as at<br>28 February 2026 | Actual average as at<br>28 February 2026 | Projected<br>2026/27 <sup>a</sup> |
|-------------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| United Nations military contingents       | –                   | 30.0                | 30.0                | 30.0                             | 32.5                                     | 30.0                              |
| ATMIS/AUSSOM military contingents         | –                   | (21.2) <sup>b</sup> | –                   | 4.4                              | 1.2                                      | –                                 |
| ATMIS/AUSSOM police personnel             | 2.9                 | 19.2                | –                   | 98.5                             | 99.0                                     | –                                 |
| ATMIS/AUSSOM formed police unit personnel | 20.3                | 21.8                | –                   | 0.6                              | 0.1                                      | –                                 |

<sup>a</sup> Details of projected planned deployment of uniformed personnel are factored into the proposed vacancy rates.

<sup>b</sup> The negative vacancy rate reflects the actual deployment against the lower initial authorized strength of 9,586 ATMIS military personnel, which was used for the formulation of the 2024/25 budget, while the authorized level evolved and increased during the period to 11,586, which was maintained until 30 June 2025.

26. The proposed resources for military and police personnel for the 2026/27 period amount to \$112,903,800, representing an increase of \$1,621,300, or 1.5 per cent, compared with the approved resources for the 2025/26 period, reflecting: (a) additional freight costs associated with the anticipated repatriation and replacement of equipment and deployment and repatriation of military personnel, in accordance with the planned AUSSOM reconfiguration; and (b) the higher average price per round-trip ticket. This is offset in part by reduced contingent-owned equipment costs resulting from a change in force composition and the shift in unit structure ([A/80/628](#), paras. 65 and 68; see also paras. 13–17 above).

### Rations

27. The proposed requirements for rations for the 2026/27 period total \$39,681,200, compared with the amount of \$39,613,600 approved for 2025/26. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the proposed budget reflects efficiency gains of approximately \$2.7 million resulting from the adjustment of the contractual ceiling

individual rate for rations to an average of \$5.53 per person per day, compared with the contractual ceiling rate of \$6.04. While the rations budget had previously been aligned with the contractual ceiling individual rate, actual food orders at UNSOS had consistently remained below the ceiling rate. In line with the Controller's budget instructions, the proposed provision is based on the average of the actual contractual ceiling individual rate over the most recent six-month period. It was, however, further noted that a new rations contract was under solicitation and that the revised contractual ceiling individual rate had yet to be determined. **The Advisory Committee trusts that updated information on the status of the rations contract will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report.**

#### *Contingent-owned equipment disposal activities*

28. The Secretary-General previously indicated that, in the 2025/26 period, UNSOS would support AUSSOM with contingent-owned equipment disposal activities, including a revised approach for mission-owned equipment, in main and temporary bases identified for closure or handover (A/79/755, para. 24; see also A/79/724/Add.10, para. 19). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 12 March 2026, UNSOS supported the in situ disposal of 59 depreciated contingent-owned equipment assets of three troop-contributing countries, thereby avoiding significant transportation, handling and repatriation costs while fully adhering to United Nations property disposal procedures. UNSOS also expanded in situ disposal for United Nations-owned equipment wherever operationally feasible, reducing the movement of obsolete assets and supporting a more efficient drawdown of outdated inventory. In addition, UNSOS streamlined end-to-end disposal workflows, reducing delays, strengthening governance and expediting write-off and disposal actions. **The Advisory Committee notes the in situ disposal of depreciated contingent-owned equipment and United Nations-owned equipment and trusts that information on related efficiency gains will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the next report.** The Committee further discusses this matter in its report on the triennial review of the rates and standards for reimbursement to Member States for contingent-owned equipment (A/80/693).

29. **The Advisory Committee recommends the approval of the proposals of the Secretary-General for military and police personnel.**

## 2. Civilian personnel

| Category                             | Approved<br>2024/25 | Encumbered as<br>at 30 June 2025 | Approved<br>2025/26 | Encumbered as at<br>28 February 2026 | Proposed<br>2026/27 | Variance    |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------|--------------------------------------|---------------------|-------------|
|                                      | (1)                 | (2)                              | (3)                 | (4)                                  | (5)                 | (6)=(5)-(3) |
| <b>Posts</b>                         |                     |                                  |                     |                                      |                     |             |
| International staff                  | 368                 | 337                              | 368                 | 292                                  | 337                 | (31)        |
| National staff                       |                     |                                  |                     |                                      |                     |             |
| National Professional Officer        | 43                  | 37                               | 42                  | 35                                   | 49                  | 7           |
| National General Service staff       | 143                 | 115                              | 143                 | 113                                  | 139                 | (4)         |
| <b>United Nations Volunteers</b>     |                     |                                  |                     |                                      |                     |             |
| International                        | 21                  | 19                               | 21                  | 0                                    | 3                   | (18)        |
| National                             | 4                   | 4                                | 4                   | 4                                    | 13                  | 9           |
| <b>General temporary assistance</b>  |                     |                                  |                     |                                      |                     |             |
| International                        | 1                   | 1                                | 2                   | 2                                    | 2                   | —           |
| <b>Government-provided personnel</b> | 8                   | 6                                | 8                   | 7                                    | 8                   | —           |
| <b>Total</b>                         | <b>588</b>          | <b>519</b>                       | <b>588</b>          | <b>453</b>                           | <b>551</b>          | <b>(37)</b> |

30. The proposed resources for civilian personnel for the 2026/27 period amount to \$104,311,700, reflecting an increase of \$5,633,700 (or 5.7 per cent), mainly due to: (a) the application of a lower vacancy rate for international posts and general temporary assistance positions; (b) the establishment of nine posts (1 P-5, 2 P-3 and 6 National Professional Officer) to ensure the continued and effective implementation of the human rights due diligence policy; and (c) higher revised salary rates for international staff, National Professional Officers and national General Service staff. The increase is offset in part by: (a) the proposed abolishment of 31 international posts and the abolishment of 15 international United Nations Volunteer positions; and (b) the proposed nationalization of 12 posts and positions ([A/80/628](#), paras. 70, 71, 75, 77 and 79).

31. The Secretary-General proposes 551 civilian posts and positions, reflecting a net decrease of 37 posts. The proposed staffing changes, which are outlined in sect. I.F of his report, reflect the following:

(a) Abolishment of 31 international posts (6 P-4, 7 P-3, 18 Field Service) and 15 international United Nations Volunteer positions, including 25 posts and positions (17 international staff and 8 international United Nations Volunteer), effective 1 November 2026, providing administrative and operational support to UNTMIS on a cost-recovery basis;

(b) Establishment of 9 posts (1 P-5, 2 P-3 and 6 National Professional Officer) (see para. 33 below);

(c) Conversion of 12 posts and positions in pursuit of nationalization efforts (see para. 34 below).

32. It is indicated in the Secretary-General's report that a civilian staffing review is scheduled for 2026 ([A/80/628](#), sect. V). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the review would provide an opportunity to further streamline staffing structures, including by identifying additional measures in support of nationalization (see para. 34 below), and to assess capacity gaps arising from the implementation of the UN80 Initiative and contingency planning.

#### *Establishment*

33. It is proposed that nine Human Rights Officer posts (1 P-5, 2 P-3 and 6 National Professional Officer) would be established, effective 1 November 2026, to ensure the continued implementation of the human rights due diligence policy following the planned closure of UNTMIS, in line with paragraphs 18 and 19 of Security Council resolution [2809 \(2025\)](#). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, to maintain coherence across all United Nations support, the Secretary-General proposes a single human rights due diligence policy structure within UNSOS, comprising 13 posts, as follows: (a) nine new posts (1 P-5, 2 P-3 and 6 National Professional Officer); (b) two existing posts related to the human rights due diligence policy under UNSOS (1 P-4 and 1 National Professional Officer); and (c) two existing posts (National Professional Officer) that would continue to be cost-shared with the United Nations country team. The proposed structure would be led by a Senior Human Rights Officer (1 P-5), supported by a human rights due diligence policy secretariat (1 P-4) and an analysis team (2 National Professional Officer), as well as three regional monitoring and engagement teams. Specific workload assumptions and metrics underpinning proposed staffing levels and configuration were requested but not provided. The Committee was instead informed that a review undertaken by the Secretariat in 2025 assessed that approximately 88 per cent of overall United Nations support to the African Union and Somali security forces was conducted by UNSOS, while 12 per cent was provided by the United Nations country team, and that a human

rights due diligence policy staffing capacity of 13 was considered the minimum required. The Committee was further informed that UNTMIS had 31 posts prior to 2026 (28 after the 2026 revised estimates) whose function was to deliver a broader human rights mandate, of which implementation of the human rights due diligence policy constituted only one component. The Committee notes that the UNTMIS human rights component was led at the D-1 level and that its senior leadership structure included three P-5 posts. Of these, two were dedicated to specialized protection functions. **In the absence of sufficiently substantiated workload metrics, and taking into account that implementation of the human rights due diligence policy under UNTMIS was embedded within a broader human rights mandate, as well as the existing P-4 human rights due diligence policy capacity in UNSOS, the Advisory Committee recommends against the establishment of the Senior Human Rights Officer post (P-5) at this stage. Any related operational costs should be adjusted accordingly. The Committee trusts that the resource requirements for the implementation of the human rights due diligence policy will be further assessed in the context of the upcoming civilian staffing review and that comprehensive information on actual and projected workload, as well as arrangements between UNSOS and the United Nations country team, will be provided in the next report.**

#### *Nationalization*

34. For the 2026/27 period, the Secretary-General proposes the nationalization of 12 posts and positions in UNSOS, comprising the conversion of: (a) three Field Service posts to two National Professional Officer posts and one national General Service post; (b) three international United Nations Volunteer positions to national United Nations Volunteer positions; and (c) five national General Service posts and one National Professional Officer to national United Nations Volunteer positions. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, of the six national posts proposed for conversion to national volunteer positions, five would be reassigned from Kenya to Somalia, while one was already located in Somalia. Furthermore, the use of the national United Nations Volunteer modality was considered a flexible, cost-effective and prudent approach to advancing nationalization and strengthening national capacity in the context of financial constraints, contingency planning considerations and the forthcoming civilian staffing review, of which nationalization is identified as a key objective. The Committee was also informed that, while no positions had been nationalized over the past five years, UNSOS had nonetheless pursued an approach to nationalization aimed at supporting capacity-building, facilitating the recruitment, retention and career progression of Somali national staff, and progressively relocating national posts from Kenya to Somalia. **Recalling paragraph 3 of General Assembly resolution 78/309, the Advisory Committee encourages greater efforts to nationalize functions commensurate with mission mandates and requirements, wherever appropriate, and trusts that the forthcoming civilian staffing review will identify concrete opportunities in this regard (see also A/79/724/Add.10, para. 27).**

#### *Vacant posts*

35. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 28 February 2026, there were 134 vacant posts and positions (1 D-2, 5 P-5, 16 P-4, 17 P-3, 37 Field Service, 7 National Professional Officer, 30 national General Service and 21 international United Nations Volunteer). Of these, 13 (2 P-4, 1 P-3, 1 Field Service, 1 National Professional Officer and 8 national General Service) had been vacant for two years or more. Of these long-standing vacant posts, two P-4 were proposed for abolishment, while one National Professional Officer and five national General

Service were proposed for conversion to national United Nations Volunteer positions. **The Advisory Committee trusts that updated information on the status of vacant posts will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the next budget submission, and that the remaining long-standing vacant posts will be critically reviewed in the next budget period.** The Committee discusses vacant and long-vacant posts in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations (A/80/604).

36. The Advisory Committee was also informed that, as at 31 December 2025, 21 posts (3 P-4, 14 Field Service and 4 national General Service) were encumbered by staff with approved requests for early separation. **The Advisory Committee trusts that detailed and updated information on staff approved for the early separation programme, as well as the related costs, will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the next budget submission.**

#### *Vacancy rates*

(Percentage)

| Category                       | Approved<br>2024/25 | Actual<br>2024/25 | Approved<br>2025/26 | Actual as at<br>31 December<br>2025 | Average,<br>January–<br>December 2025 | Actual as at<br>28 February<br>2026 | Average<br>July 2025–<br>February 2026 | Proposed<br>2026/27 |
|--------------------------------|---------------------|-------------------|---------------------|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|---------------------|
| <b>Civilian personnel</b>      |                     |                   |                     |                                     |                                       |                                     |                                        |                     |
| International staff            | 8.2                 | 7.6               | 7.6                 | 11.7                                | 9.0                                   | 20.7                                | 12.8                                   | 2.7                 |
| National staff                 |                     |                   |                     |                                     |                                       |                                     |                                        |                     |
| National Professional Officers | 23.8                | 14.0              | 14.0                | 11.9                                | 14.0                                  | 16.7                                | 11.9                                   | 9.8                 |
| National General Service staff | 7.7                 | 14.0              | 9.8                 | 19.6                                | 18.2                                  | 21.0                                | 19.6                                   | 16.7                |
| United Nations Volunteers      |                     |                   |                     |                                     |                                       |                                     |                                        |                     |
| International                  | 19.0                | 4.8               | 4.8                 | 19.0                                | 9.5                                   | 100.0                               | 23.8                                   | –                   |
| National                       | 25.0                | –                 | –                   | –                                   | –                                     | –                                   | –                                      | –                   |
| General temporary assistance   |                     |                   |                     |                                     |                                       |                                     |                                        |                     |
| International                  | –                   | –                 | –                   | –                                   | –                                     | –                                   | –                                      | –                   |
| Government-provided personnel  | 14.3                | 25.0              | 12.5                | 12.5                                | 12.5                                  | 12.5                                | 12.5                                   | 12.5                |

37. **The Advisory Committee notes the difference between the actual and proposed vacancy rates for international staff, national staff and United Nations Volunteers. In particular, the proposed vacancy rates for international and national staff are significantly lower than the current actual rates. The Committee further notes that the proposed vacancy rates for national staff (9.8 per cent for National Professional Officers and 16.7 per cent for General Service) are proportionally higher than the rate proposed for international staff (2.7 per cent). The Committee trusts that the Secretary-General will provide updated information on the latest actual and actual average vacancy rates to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report, along with clear justification where the proposed rates differ from the actual rates, including as it relates to proposed abolishments, realistic projected recruitment and potential upcoming vacancies, to the extent possible.**

38. Subject to its recommendation in paragraph 33 above, the Advisory Committee recommends the approval of the proposals of the Secretary-General for civilian personnel.

### 3. Operational costs

(Thousands of United States dollars)

| Category                                     | Apportionment<br>(2024/25) | Expenditure<br>(2024/25) | Apportionment<br>(2025/26) | Expenditure as<br>at 28 February<br>2026 | Cost<br>estimates<br>(2026/27) | Variance          |               |
|----------------------------------------------|----------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------|---------------|
|                                              |                            |                          |                            |                                          |                                | Amount            | Percentage    |
|                                              | (1)                        | (2)                      | (3)                        | (4)                                      | (5)                            | (6)=(5)-(3)       | (7)=(6)÷(3)   |
| <b>Operational costs</b>                     |                            |                          |                            |                                          |                                |                   |               |
| Civilian electoral observers                 | —                          | —                        | —                          | —                                        | —                              | —                 | —             |
| Consultants and consulting services          | 372.1                      | 331.9                    | 432.4                      | 54.6                                     | 370.0                          | (62.4)            | (14.4)        |
| Official travel                              | 1 555.9                    | 978.0                    | 1 280.5                    | 344.6                                    | 1 129.9                        | (150.6)           | (11.8)        |
| Facilities and infrastructure                | 87 341.8                   | 82 476.6                 | 93 069.4                   | 34 233.0                                 | 83 509.0                       | (9 560.4)         | (10.3)        |
| Ground transportation                        | 11 967.6                   | 9 584.7                  | 13 995.2                   | 4 382.3                                  | 11 809.8                       | (2 185.4)         | (15.6)        |
| Air operations                               | 100 504.8                  | 88 535.6                 | 112 286.3                  | 40 137.0                                 | 93 606.9                       | (18 679.4)        | (16.6)        |
| Marine operations                            | 578.0                      | 459.6                    | 540.5                      | 96.5                                     | 416.1                          | (124.4)           | (23.0)        |
| Communications and information<br>technology | 33 800.8                   | 30 854.2                 | 33 005.6                   | 16 510.4                                 | 25 156.1                       | (7 849.5)         | (23.8)        |
| Medical                                      | 7 919.8                    | 6 528.7                  | 8 261.1                    | 3 156.6                                  | 9 309.6                        | 1 048.5           | 12.7          |
| Special equipment                            | —                          | —                        | —                          | —                                        | —                              | —                 | —             |
| Other supplies, services and equipment       | 50 443.2                   | 47 438.9                 | 47 796.4                   | 21 037.6                                 | 39 148.9                       | (8 647.5)         | (18.1)        |
| Quick-impact projects                        | —                          | —                        | —                          | —                                        | —                              | —                 | —             |
| <b>Total</b>                                 | <b>294 484.0</b>           | <b>267 188.2</b>         | <b>310 667.4</b>           | <b>119 952.6</b>                         | <b>264 456.3</b>               | <b>(46 211.1)</b> | <b>(14.9)</b> |

39. The proposed resources for operational costs for the 2026/27 period amount to \$264,456,300, representing a decrease of \$46,211,100 (or 14.9 per cent) compared with the approved level for 2025/26. Lower requirements are reflected under all budget categories, with the exception of medical. **The Advisory Committee notes the proposed reduction of \$46.2 million (or 14.9 per cent) under operational costs, notwithstanding anticipated additional requirements arising from the closure of UNTMIS as well as the ongoing reconfiguration of AUSSOM.**

#### *Facilities and infrastructure*

40. Proposed requirements under facilities and infrastructure amount to \$83,509,000, representing a decrease of \$9,560,400, or 10.3 per cent, attributable primarily to: (a) lower construction costs, following the expected finalization of security upgrades to withstand the impact of attacks with 107 mm rockets; (b) the lower acquisition of facilities and accommodation and safety and security-related equipment due to the availability of existing stock; and (c) lower fuel consumption. The decrease is partly offset by the provision of \$8,976,600 for the inclusion of armed static security costs for UNSOS compounds, previously funded under UNTMIS (see para. 48 below) and the replacement of water treatment plants that have exceeded their operational lifespan (A/80/628, paras. 85 and 86).

#### *Air operations*

41. Proposed requirements for air operations for the 2026/27 period amount to \$93,606,900, reflecting a decrease of \$18,679,400, or 16.6 per cent, attributable primarily to: (a) the termination of the contracts for two fixed-wing and two rotary-wing aircraft; (b) lower rental and operating costs of military rotary-wing aircraft in line with the AUSSOM fleet reconfiguration and the application of a 50 per cent

delayed deployment factor; and (c) lower cost for aviation crew accommodation and catering, which are expected to be integrated into existing UNSOS facilities. The reduced requirements are offset in part by the planned deployment of one uncrewed aerial system to provide aerial intelligence, surveillance and reconnaissance services to AUSSOM as part of critical security enhancement, with the application of a 50 per cent delayed factor (*ibid.*, paras. 90 and 91). The Advisory Committee notes expenditures of \$88,535,600 and \$94,099,800 against appropriations of \$100,504,800 and \$94,623,100 in the 2024/25 and 2023/24 periods, respectively.

42. Information provided to the Advisory Committee indicates that the proposed UNSOS air fleet for 2026/27 would comprise 26 aircraft: 3 fixed-wing aircraft and 23 helicopters. Upon enquiry, the Committee was informed that, in the 2025/26 period, while the approved level of military aviation assets comprised 17 helicopters, their number declined to 10. Two helicopters crashed and one became unserviceable, with no replacements received, and the planned deployment of four new helicopters did not materialize owing to the liquidity crisis. The Committee was further informed that, in prior and current periods, delayed deployment and limited asset availability resulted in lower actual flight hours, reduced operational flexibility and the need to prioritize essential tasks such as troop mobility, medical evacuation and resupply to remote locations.

43. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the proposed total of 11,038 flight hours represents a reduction of 16.6 per cent from 13,236 hours approved for 2025/26. This estimate assumes the deployment of 11 new aircraft and the related application of a six-month delayed deployment factor, in line with the Secretariat's budget policy across peacekeeping missions. For UNSOS, this assumption reflects the anticipated time required to finalize memorandums of understanding and letters of assist, as well as related operational planning, preparation and deployment arrangements. The projected reduction in flight hours is also based on AUSSOM operational reconfiguration assumptions and incorporates historical utilization data as well as prevailing technical constraints to ensure that the projected flight hours are operationally attainable. Should full deployment occur earlier than anticipated or operational demand increase, UNSOS would scale up utilization within existing capacity, subject to the availability of funds. **The Advisory Committee notes that the proposed budget under air operations corresponds to a 16.6 per cent reduction compared with the approved level for the current period, while the proposed air fleet would comprise 26 aircraft, representing an increase of 7 air assets above the number currently deployed. The Committee further notes that the deployment of a significant portion of the proposed fleet (11 of 26 aircraft, or over 40 per cent) remains subject to ongoing arrangements and acknowledges that the budget applies a 50 per cent delayed deployment factor. While cognizant that UNSOS is operating at a transitional juncture (see section IV.A above), the Committee trusts that future budget submissions will present a clearer and more realistic assessment of operational requirements under air operations and the corresponding budget assumptions, with further clarification on the relationship between the proposed fleet composition, expected deployment timelines and projected utilization levels to ensure that resource requirements are fully aligned with operational needs and that the projected flight hours are operationally attainable.**

#### *Medical*

44. Proposed requirements for medical services amount to \$9,309,600, reflecting an increase of \$1,048,500, or 12.7 per cent, mainly owing to: (a) UNSOS assuming full financial responsibility for level I+ and level III medical services following the end

of the UNTMIS mandate; and (b) the replacement of outdated or non-functional medical equipment (*ibid.*, para. 97).

*Petrol, oil and lubricants*

45. A total provision of \$39,990,700 for fuel, oil and lubricants is proposed for 2026/27, reflecting a decrease of \$1,180,900, or 2.9 per cent, compared with the 2025/26 period, owing to a reduction in projected fuel consumption (litres) and lower operations and maintenance costs, offset in part by the impact of higher fuel prices. The variance is reflected across four budget classes, as follows: decreases under facilities and infrastructure (\$609,800), ground transportation (\$1,218,000), marine operations (\$3,500), partially offset by increased requirements under air operations (\$650,400). **The Advisory Committee trusts that updated information on fuel costs will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report.**

46. The Advisory Committee recalls that, in response to challenges with fuel contracts involving UNSOS and other missions, the Department of Operational Support had been examining the possibility of restructuring the fuel supply chain and awarding multiple contracts per mission ([A/79/724/Add.10](#), para. 34). Upon enquiry, the Committee was informed that UNSOS and United Nations Headquarters completed a procurement process for bulk fuel services, awarding three primary contracts, including one to a Somali-based company that will supply most distribution points. Under the new contract, all distribution points will be supplied by road for Jet A1 and diesel, except for Baidoa and Jowhar, which will continue to rely on air delivery. Furthermore, UNSOS will continue to pursue efficiencies in fuel management through tighter consumption controls, monitoring through the electronic fuel management system, renewable energy measures and optimized air operations. **The Advisory Committee trusts that the measures put in place will result in strengthened fuel management and further efficiency gains, and that updated information thereon will be provided in the next report.** The Committee further discusses fuel management issues in its reports on the report of the Board of Auditors ([A/80/633](#)) and on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

47. **The Advisory Committee recommends the approval of the proposals of the Secretary-General for operational costs.**

## V. Other matters

*Security situation*

48. In his report, the Secretary-General indicates that in 2026/27 UNSOS will continue to operate in a complex environment characterized by a fragile security situation, facing both direct threats and risks arising from the broader security environment. The report further indicates that UNSOS was reviewing options to ensure continuity of essential armed security services after the closure of UNTMIS, in view of the anticipated withdrawal of the United Nations Guard Unit, which provides static armed security for United Nations personnel, premises and assets in Mogadishu ([A/80/628](#), paras. 13 and 14). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that one option would entail the continuation or redeployment of the Guard Unit, with reduced personnel (from 625 to 425 personnel) supplemented by private security personnel. This option, which has been assessed as the most reliable and implementable by a series of United Nations security teams, provides a formed and well-trained military capability that is able to respond robustly during in extremis situations and deploy an armoured emergency response team and that operates under established and tested procedures in coordination with AUSSOM and the Department

of Safety and Security. Another option would entail the engagement of a private security company, which would offer scalability and reduced requirements for accommodation, but would present higher staffing and training costs, potential insider threat risks of infiltration by armed groups and limited capacity to respond during in extremis situations. As an interim measure, the existing provider could temporarily increase capacity to ensure uninterrupted coverage pending final arrangements. The cost implications of the two options are broadly comparable, and the resource requirements included in the proposed budget (\$8.9 million) would be utilized flexibly depending on the modality that is ultimately endorsed. **The Advisory Committee trusts that any further assessment will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and that updated information will be included in the next report.**

49. The report further indicates that, in response to evolving threats, including increased uncrewed aerial vehicle activity with suspected hostile intent, UNSOS has strengthened early warning and counter-uncrewed aerial vehicle capabilities, in collaboration with the Department of Safety and Security and international partners (*ibid.*, para. 5). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that UNDSS had assessed the risk of UAV attack and/or interception of United Nations property, including aircraft, as low. Infrastructure upgrades at key UNSOS locations, including overhead protection, side protection and bunkers, are sufficient to counter the current drone threat. However, a full multilayered counter-uncrewed aerial vehicle system consisting of kinetic and non-kinetic interdiction measures is still required, and UNSOS is upgrading five early warning systems from five-channel to nine-channel capability to enhance detection accuracy, reliability and continuity of support. **The Advisory Committee trusts that detailed information on planned and adopted risk mitigation measures, along with the related cost implications, will be provided in the next report.** The Committee further discusses related matters in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

#### *Management of sea containers*

50. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 31 January 2026, UNSOS managed a total of 6,419 containers. Of these, 6,085 containers were used for storage purposes, 266 served as accommodation or shelter units and 62 supported specialized functions. Over the past year, UNSOS strengthened its container oversight and stock management processes, with unserviceable containers and materials systematically identified and processed for disposal in accordance with relevant procedures. The Committee further discusses the management of containers in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

#### *Environmental initiatives*

51. During the 2026/27 period, UNSOS will install additional solar-powered water treatment plants, complemented by solar photovoltaic systems aimed at reducing its carbon footprint. Furthermore, UNSOS plans to procure portable chlorine generators to enable efficient and easier transportation, on-site water treatment and enhanced operational flexibility in remote locations. UNSOS will also conduct comprehensive environmental management training to AUSSOM, focusing on responsible waste disposal, efficient use of natural resources, compliance with environmental protection standards and the safe handling of hazardous materials (see [A/80/628](#), paras. 27 and 28). **The Advisory Committee notes the efforts of UNSOS to improve its environmental footprint and trusts that further efficiency gains will be generated from energy and environmental initiatives and reflected in future reports.** The Committee further discusses environmental activities in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

*Equitable geographical representation and gender parity*

52. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 28 February 2026, UNSOS comprised 440 staff at all levels. Among the 293 international staff members, 84 nationalities were represented. Of the total 440 staff, 143 were women and 297 were men.

53. As at the same date, UNSOS international staff were from the following regional groups: African States (142), Asia Pacific States (67), Eastern European States (31), Latin American and Caribbean States (9), Western European and other States (32), as well as from the United States of America (10) and others (2).

54. **The Advisory Committee trusts that UNSOS will further increase its efforts to promote equitable geographical representation and gender parity.** The Committee discusses equitable geographical representation and gender parity in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

## VI. Conclusion

55. The actions to be taken by the General Assembly with respect to the financing of UNSOS for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 are presented in section IV of the report of the Secretary-General ([A/80/628](#)). **The Advisory Committee notes the unencumbered balance of \$13,471,300 for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025, as well as other revenue/adjustments amounting to \$3,884,000 from investment revenue (\$199,700), other/miscellaneous revenue (\$37,700) and the cancellation of prior-period obligations (\$3,646,600) for the period ended 30 June 2025. The Committee also notes the proposal of the Secretary-General to place the credits arising from the above-mentioned revenue and adjustments in a reserve that would be used in the event that collections are insufficient to enable the full, efficient and effective implementation of mandates. The Committee considers that this is a policy matter to be decided by the General Assembly.** The Committee makes further comments in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

56. The actions to be taken by the General Assembly with respect to the financing of UNSOS for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 are presented in section IV of the report of the Secretary-General ([A/80/628](#)). **Taking into account its observations and recommendations above, the Advisory Committee recommends that the proposed resources be reduced by \$121,400, from \$481,671,800 to \$481,550,400. Accordingly, the Committee recommends that the General Assembly appropriate the amount of \$481,550,400 for the maintenance of UNSOS for the 12-month period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027.** A summary of the budgetary impact and the financial implications resulting from the recommendations of the Committee with regard to the financing of UNSOS for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 is presented in the table below.

**Budgetary impact and financial implications resulting from the recommendations of the Advisory Committee for the United Nations Support Office in Somalia for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027**

| Category | Paragraph<br>number<br>(present report) | Recommendation of the Advisory Committee | Financial implication<br>(United States<br>dollars) |
|----------|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
|          |                                         |                                          |                                                     |

**Posts/staffing changes**

| <i>Category</i>     | <i>Paragraph<br/>number<br/>(present report)</i> | <i>Recommendation of the Advisory Committee</i>                                                                                                                                   | <i>Financial implication<br/>(United States<br/>dollars)</i> |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| International staff | 33                                               | The Advisory Committee recommends against the establishment of the Senior Human Rights Officer (P-5) at this stage. Any related operational costs should be adjusted accordingly. | (121 400)                                                    |
| <b>Total</b>        |                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>(121 400)</b>                                             |